

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:
Purchased _____

-----X
EDWIN CARTAGENA,

Plaintiff,

Plaintiff designates
New York County as the place of trial

-against-

The basis of the venue is where the
tort arose

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. VERONICA
NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID
#956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ
SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER
WHO PLACED PLAINTIFF IN HANDCUFFS N/H/A
JOHN/JANE DOE I, OTHER NEW YORK CITY
POLICE OFFICERS INVOLVED IN THE ARREST
UNDER DOCKET #2016NY026277 WHOSE NAMES
ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME N/H/A
JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE
INCIDENT THAT OCCURRED ON APRIL 24, 2016
AND NO OTHER,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff resides at

EDWIN CARTAGENA
2965 East 196th Street
Bronx, New York 10461

Defendants.

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TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANT:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED, to answer the complaint in this
action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this
summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days
after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after
the service is complete) if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State
of New York and, in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken
against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bayside, New York
October 24, 2017


JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC
BY: JOHN K. KOUROUPAS
Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)
42-40 Bell Boulevard Suite 500
Bayside, New York 11361
(718) 281-0400 / (718) 281-4000

Defendants' Addresses:

**CORPORATION COUNSEL OF THE
CITY OF NEW YORK**

100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT.

SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130

2271 8th Avenue
New York, New York 10027

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

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EDWIN CARTAGENA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. VERONICA
NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID
#956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ
SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER
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AND NO OTHER,

Defendants.

-----X

EDWIN CARTAGENA, by his attorneys, JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES
PLLC, respectfully alleges as follows:

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

1. At all times mentioned, Plaintiff EDWIN CARTAGENA was a resident of
Bronx County, City and State of New York.
2. At all times mentioned, Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, was and is a
municipal corporation duly organized and existing by virtue of the laws of
the State of New York.
3. On or about the 22nd day of May, 2017 and within ninety (90) days after some
of the claims herein arose, the Plaintiff served a Notice of Claim in writing
sworn to on their behalf upon the Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, by

delivering a copy thereof in duplicate to the officer designated to receive such process personally, which Notice of Claim advised the Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, of the nature, place, time and manner in which the claim arose, the items of damage and injuries sustained so far as was then determinable.

4. At least thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service of the claim prior to the commencement of this action and adjustment of payment thereof has been neglected or refused, and this action has been commenced within one year and ninety (90) days after the happening of the event upon which the claims are based.
5. The Plaintiff has complied with the request of the municipal Defendant's for an oral examination pursuant to Section 50-H of the General Municipal Law and/or the Public Authorities Law and/or no such request was made within the applicable period.
6. Upon information and belief, at all times mentioned, Defendants P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID #953329, THE OFFICER WHO PLACED PLAINTIFF IN HANDCUFFS N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I, OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS INVOLVED IN THE ARREST UNDER DOCKET #2016NY026277 WHOSE NAMES ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, were and are police officers of the Defendant City of New York, and at all

times herein were acting in such capacity as the agents, servants and employees of the Defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**.

7. On or about April 24, 2016, at approximately 1:30P.M., in the vicinity of East 129th Street and 3rd Avenue Bridge, County of New York, State of New York the Defendants jointly and severally in their capacity as police officers, wrongfully touched, grabbed, handcuffed and seized the Plaintiff **EDWIN CARTAGENA**, in an excessive manner about his person, causing him physical pain and mental suffering. At no time did the Defendants have legal cause to grab, handcuff seize or touch the Plaintiff, nor did the Plaintiff consent to this illegal touching nor was it privileged by law.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

8. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "7" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
9. On or about April 24, 2016, at approximately 1:30P.M. in the vicinity of East 129th Street and 3rd Avenue Bridge, County of New York, State of New York, the Defendants jointly and severally did place Plaintiff **EDWIN CARTAGENA** in imminent fear of physical contact by approaching the Plaintiff with their loaded firearms, outstretched limbs and other objects which they used to physically seize, strike and restrain the Plaintiff. All of the above actions placed the Plaintiff in imminent fear of physical contact. At no time did the Plaintiff consent to the unlawful actions of the Defendants.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

10. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "9" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
11. On or about April 24, 2016, at approximately 1:30P.M. in the vicinity of East 129th Street and 3rd Avenue Bridge, County of New York, State of New York the Defendants, jointly and severally without any warrant, order or other legal process and without any legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrested the Plaintiff, restrained him and his liberty and then took him into custody to a police station in the County of New York and there charged him with the crimes on Docket No. 2016NY026277. The Plaintiff was thereafter held in custody over the course of three (3) days or approximately thirty-six (36) hours until he was released. The Defendants intentionally confined the Plaintiff without his consent and the confinement was not otherwise privileged by law and, at all times, the Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

12. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "11" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
13. On or about April 24, 2016, at approximately 1:30P.M., in the vicinity of East 129th Street and 3rd Avenue Bridge, County of New York, State of New York the Defendants, jointly and severally without any valid warrant, order or

other legal process and without any legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrested the Plaintiff, restrained him and his liberty and then took him into custody to a police station in the County of New York and there charged him with the crimes on Docket No. 2016NY026277. The Plaintiff was thereafter held in custody over the course of three (3) days or approximately thirty-six (36) hours before he was released. The Defendants intentionally confined the Plaintiff without his consent and the confinement was not otherwise privileged by law and, at all times, the Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

14. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "13" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.
15. Upon information and belief, on or about April 24, 2016 and from that time until the dismissal of charges on or about February 22, 2017, which was a favorable termination for the accused by the Honorable Judge, Part C, presiding at New York County Criminal Court, Defendants **THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER WHO PLACED PLAINTIFF IN HANDCUFFS N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I, OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS INVOLVED IN THE ARREST UNDER DOCKET #2016NY026277 WHOSE NAMES ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME**

N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, an innocent man without any probable cause whatsoever, by filing or causing a criminal court complaint to be filed in the Criminal Court of the City of New York, New York County, for the purpose of falsely accusing the plaintiff of violations of the criminal laws of the State of New York.

16. The Defendants, jointly and severally, their agents, servants or employees failed to take reasonable steps to stop the prosecution of the Plaintiff and instead maliciously and deliberately provided false and/or incomplete information to the District Attorney's office to induce prosecution of the Plaintiff and due to the absence of probable cause malice can be inferred.
17. The commencement of these criminal proceedings under Docket No. 2016NY026277 was malicious and began in malice and without probable cause, so that the proceedings could succeed by the Defendants.
18. As a result of the malicious prosecution, Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty and suffered the humiliation, mental anguish, indignity and frustration of an unjust criminal prosecution. The Plaintiff made multiple court appearances to defend his liberty against these unjust charges.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

(This Cause of action only applies against the Individually named Police Officers not the City of New York or officers sued in their official capacity)

19. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "18" with full force and effect as though set forth

at length herein.

20. Defendants P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER WHO PLACED PLAINTIFF IN HANDCUFFS N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I, OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS INVOLVED IN THE ARREST UNDER DOCKET #2016NY026277 WHOSE NAMES ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, were at all times relevant, duly appointed and acting officers of the City of New York Police Department.
21. At all times mentioned herein, said police officers were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.
22. Plaintiff EDWIN CARTAGENA is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.
23. The Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK is a municipality duly incorporated under the laws of the State of New York.
24. On or about April 24, 2016, the Defendants, armed police, while effectuating the seizure of the Plaintiff EDWIN CARTAGENA, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the person of the Plaintiff without a court authorized arrest or search warrant. They did physically seize the person of the Plaintiff during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner.

The Plaintiff was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned, assaulted, and had multiple batteries committed against him, without the Defendants possessing probable cause to do so. The officer who signed the criminal court complaint against the plaintiff was **P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130**. The named officer processed the arrest of the Plaintiff; and/or otherwise, along with those named as **"JOHN/JANE DOE I-III"** assisted in the investigation that led to the arrest of the Plaintiff. Plaintiff is unaware of the names of the officers, aside from those officers already named. Plaintiff was illegally stopped on his motorcycle by NYPD officers believed to be **P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130**, and/or **FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329**. Plaintiff was then unlawfully detained by said officers and unlawfully arrested even though he had not committed any crime of violation of the law. Plaintiff had an assault and battery and/or excessive force committed to his person while officer(s) unknown at this time, but may be **FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329** by being placed in handcuffs that cause injury to his person and/or failure to use two handcuffs to effectuate the arrest and by lifting him by the handcuffs. The handcuffs were placed on Plaintiff's wrists so tight that Plaintiff's wrists turned red. Plaintiff went to Harlem Hospital for treatment of injuries sustained during this incident.

25. The above action of the Defendants resulted in the Plaintiff being deprived of the following rights protected under the United States Constitution:
- a. Freedom from assault to his person;
 - b. Freedom from battery to his person;
 - c. Freedom from illegal search and seizure;
 - d. Freedom from false arrest;
 - e. Freedom from malicious prosecution;
 - f. Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process;
 - g. Freedom from unlawful imprisonment;
 - h. Freedom from loss of his liberty.
 - i. Freedom from being illegally searched.
26. The Defendants subjected the Plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the Plaintiff's rights or with deliberate indifference to those rights protected under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.
27. The direct and proximate result of the Defendants' acts are that the Plaintiff has suffered severe and permanent injuries of a psychological nature. He was forced to endure pain and suffering, all to his detriment.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

28. Plaintiff incorporates, repeats and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in Paragraphs "1" through "27" with full force and effect as though set forth at length herein.

29. Defendant **CITY OF NEW YORK** has grossly failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when its police officers are not in possession of a court authorized arrest warrant and where an individual, especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based on probable cause.
30. **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** was negligent by failing to implement a policy with its Police Department and instruct police officers who, absent the consent of the Plaintiff (or similarly situated individuals) or without the possession of a court authorized arrest, a search warrant, said police officers of the City of New York are not to arrest individuals such as the Plaintiff here where probable cause is lacking and the use of force should only be reasonable when an individual resists arrest and should not be used where a criminal defendant is not resisting arrest.
31. **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** is negligent due to its failure to implement a policy with its Police Department or actively enforce the law, if any of the following are lacking:
1. Probable cause must be present before an individual such as the Plaintiff herein can be arrested.
 2. Excessive force cannot be used against an individual who does not physically resist arrest.

3. An individual who sustains physical injury at the hands of the police during the arrest process should receive prompt medical attention.
31. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY OF NEW YORK which caused the police officers to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, seize illegally and search the Plaintiff commit an assault/battery to his person and denied him prompt medical attention under the belief that they would suffer no disciplinary actions for their failure to take proper or prudent steps in this case.

AS AND FOR AN EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

32. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges all of the allegations contained in paragraphs "1" through "31" as it set forth at length herein.
33. Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK was negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the Police Officer Defendants, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said Defendants or had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that these officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY OF NEW YORK and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants, together with the costs and disbursements of this action in the amount of damages greater than the

jurisdictional limit of any lower court where otherwise have jurisdiction, together with attorneys' fees and costs for bringing this case and punitive damages.

Dated: Bayside, New York
October 24, 2017

Yours, etc.

JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC

BY:  JOHN K. KOUROUPAS
Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)
42-40 Bell Boulevard Suite 500
Bayside, New York 11361
(718) 281-0400 / (718) 281-4000

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

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EDWIN CARTAGENA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

VERIFICATION

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. VERONICA
NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID
#956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ
SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER
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ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME N/H/A
JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE
INCIDENT THAT OCCURRED ON APRIL 24, 2016
AND NO OTHER,

Defendants.

-----X

I, JOHN K. KOUROUPAS, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am a member of the firm of JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC, the attorneys of record for Plaintiffs in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff is because Plaintiff resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
October 24, 2017


JOHN K. KOUROUPAS

Index No. :

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

EDWIN CARTAGENA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. VERONICA NICKEY OF THE 28 PCT., SHIELD #15241, TAX ID #956130, FORMER P.O. ALFONSO RODRIGUEZ SHIELD #12765, TAX ID#953329, THE OFFICER WHO PLACED PLAINTIFF IN HANDCUFFS N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE I, OTHER NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS INVOLVED IN THE ARREST UNDER DOCKET #2016NY026277 WHOSE NAMES ARE NOT KNOWN AT THIS TIME N/H/A JOHN/JANE DOE II-III, AS IT PERTAINS TO THE INCIDENT THAT OCCURRED ON APRIL 24, 2016 AND NO OTHER,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JOHN R. DEPAOLA & ASSOCIATES PLLC
BY: JOHN K. KOUROUPAS
Attorney for Plaintiff(s)
42-40 Bell Boulevard
Bayside, NY 11361
Tel. (718) 281-4000

To: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF NEW YORK CITY

Attorney(s) for Defendants

Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.

Dated

Attorney(s) for